FOR GEISHA RESTAURANTS — ASIA & FUSION

Your booking system: safety, backups and downtime

A plain-English answer to two fair questions — what happens if the booking system stops working, and could we ever lose the bookings?

August 2026 · Reviewed every three months

The short answer

COULD WE LOSE BOOKINGS?

No

Every reservation is copied somewhere else within ten seconds of being taken.

WORST CASE, HOW LONG?

15 min

A second machine in another country is ready to take over. Most problems clear in under five minutes.

WHERE IS IT ALL KEPT?

2 countries

Your diary exists in two places at once, with two separate companies, plus backups held by a third.

Think of it like the old paper reservations book. If that book were lost or went up in smoke, everything in it would be gone, and there would be nothing to be done about it.

Your booking system is photocopied every ten seconds, and the copies are kept in another country, by a different company. If anything happened to the original, you would lose at most the last few seconds — and you would have it all back within the hour, not the same week.

Two machines, two companies

Your booking system is not one machine sitting in a cupboard. There are two, in two different countries, rented from two unrelated companies and kept in step with each other second by second — and the websites themselves run somewhere else again.

THE PART	WHERE IT IS	WHAT IT DOES
The main machine where your bookings live	London	Holds the diary, the tables and your guest records. This is the one doing the work day to day.
The standby machine a second copy, ready to go	Germany, with a different company	Kept continuously up to date with the first. If the main machine ever stops, this one takes over and the restaurant carries on.
Your websites and the staff diary	Spread across many machines	Run by a third company on a large network rather than any single computer, so there is no one machine to lose. Faults here clear themselves, usually in seconds.

> **Why using two separate companies matters**
>
> A single computer, however well looked after, is one thing going wrong away from a very bad day. Two machines would fix that — but two machines rented from the *same* company still share one account, one bill and one supplier having a bad week.
>
> Yours are deliberately with **two unrelated companies, in two countries**. There is no single account, invoice, password or supplier whose failure could take both of them away. The failure that would once have closed your booking system for a morning becomes a switch-over measured in minutes.

Your bookings sit on machines of your own

Both machines are reserved for Geisha and nothing else — not shared with any other business. That rules out an entire category of problem: somebody else's system having a bad day and taking your diary down with it.

Everything stays within the UK and the European Union, so your guests' details are covered by the same data protection rules throughout and never travel further than they should.

How your bookings are kept safe

On top of the standby machine, there are three separate backups. Each one covers something the others cannot.

> **1. A live copy — every ten seconds**
>
> Every booking, change and cancellation is copied to secure storage held by a third company within about ten seconds of happening. If both machines were somehow lost in the middle of a Saturday service, that evening's bookings would still be safe somewhere else again.

> **2. A full copy every night — kept for two weeks**
>
> At four o'clock each morning the entire diary is saved, and the last fourteen days are kept. This is the one that answers *"something was deleted last Tuesday and we've only just noticed"* — any day in the last fortnight can be looked at and recovered.

> **3. A copy of the whole machine every day**
>
> Once a day a complete copy of the main machine is taken and kept for a week. The first two copies bring back your *bookings*; this one brings back the *computer*, set up exactly as it was.

Alongside those, every change to a booking is logged with who made it and when, so a question like *"who moved table nine?"* always has an answer. And every confirmed booking sends the guest an email, which is a record of the reservation sitting safely outside the system altogether.

> **The backups are tested, not just taken**
>
> A backup nobody has ever restored is only a hope. Every three months, and after any significant change, a backup is restored for real onto a spare machine and the bookings counted to make sure they are all there. That rehearsal is timed — and the fifteen-minute figure on the first page comes from those rehearsals, not from guesswork.

If something does go wrong

WHAT'S HAPPENED	WHAT YOU AND YOUR GUESTS WOULD NOTICE	BACK TO NORMAL
The restaurant's internet drops	Guests carry on booking online as normal — the system doesn't live in your building. Staff screens show a red warning and switch to the stored list of today's tables.	Straight away
A fault on the websites	A brief interruption to online booking, which clears itself. The phone still rings and bookings can be taken as usual.	Under 5 min
The main booking machine fails	The standby takes over. A guest booking at that exact moment may need to try again. Your team keeps working from the day's table list.	15 min
Something is deleted by mistake	Usually spotted by your team rather than by a guest.	15–45 min

Your team can keep working throughout

Every phone, tablet and till that has opened the diary keeps its own copy of the day's bookings on the device. If the internet or the system goes down, that copy is still there — arrival times, guest names, number of covers, table numbers, phone numbers and allergy notes — and it can be printed. Service carries on, and anything taken over the phone is added afterwards.

During a problem that list can be read but not changed. That is deliberate: two members of staff seating the same table from two screens that can't talk to each other causes far more damage than a quiet ten minutes. The system is built to be **trustworthy** when it is struggling, rather than to look like it is working when it isn't.

You won't be the one to spot it

Everything is checked every minute from the outside by an independent service, and a problem raises an alarm by email and phone immediately. Nobody is waiting for a guest to complain or a host to ring round. Warnings also come through days in advance if a machine is starting to run short of room.

What it costs

All of the above — two machines of your own in two countries, daily copies of the main one, live off-site backups and round-the-clock monitoring — comes to about **£11 a month**.

WHAT YOU'RE PAYING FOR	WHY IT'S THERE	PER MONTH
The main machine London, yours alone	Your bookings on your own equipment, safe from anyone else's problems	$6.00
The standby machine Germany, a different company	The one that turns a serious failure into a fifteen-minute switch-over	$6.50
A daily copy of the main machine kept for a week	Brings it back exactly as it was, without rebuilding it by hand	$1.80
Off-site backup storage the ten-second and nightly copies	A diary's worth of bookings is tiny, so this falls inside the free allowance	Free
Round-the-clock monitoring checked every minute	Alarms by email and phone, within the free allowance at this size	Free
Total, on top of your existing website costs		**$14.30**

These are the published prices of the companies involved, correct in August 2026, and are billed in US dollars and euros — $14.30 is roughly £11 a month. There is no mark-up added.

The storage really is free rather than free-for-now: a restaurant diary is a very small amount of information, so a fortnight of backups sits comfortably inside the allowance included as standard. Even ten times your current number of bookings would not change that.

The standby machine does not need its own daily copy — it is already a copy, and the off-site backups cover it. Without the standby altogether the figure would be about £6 a month, and a serious failure would mean around half an hour rather than fifteen minutes. Nothing would be lost either way; the difference is purely how quickly you are back.

In one paragraph

Nobody can honestly promise that a computer will never fail. What can be promised, and what this document sets out, is that a failure would be **noticed within a minute, fixed within fifteen, and unable to cost you more than ten seconds of bookings** — and that each of those is tested every three months rather than simply hoped for. That is the difference between a system that was down briefly one Tuesday and one that lost the customer book. Yours is firmly the first.